

dorm dao



Oregon

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Mitau



RAILGUN \$RAIL

Railgun, \$RAIL

Executive Summary

Pitch Executive Summary
05/26/2026

Pitch Summary

Rating	Undervalued/ Overvalued/ Fairly Valued
Current Price	\$3.42
Price Target	\$7.00

Action Recommended	Buy
Recommended Size	1.5 ETH
Native Staking	Yes

Key Statistics

Network	Ethereum
Token Standard	ERC-20
Category	Privacy
SubCategory	Privacy as a service
Circulating Market Cap (\$M)	\$87.2M
Fully Diluted Market Cap (\$M)	\$87.2M
52 Week Price Range	\$0.77-\$5.67
24-Hour Trading Volume	\$4,461,202
TVL	\$92M
Last Week Protocol Fees	\$80.52K

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Category Overview & Thesis

Going into 2026, on-chain privacy has moved from a niche subcategory to foundational infrastructure. As institutions, professional traders, and everyday users increasingly demand confidentiality, we believe privacy will become a default feature on the EVM stack.

Project Overview

RAILGUN is an ownerless, on-chain smart contract app deployed across Ethereum, BSC, Polygon, and Arbitrum, that uses ZK cryptography to enable fully private smart contract interactions without leaving the host chain. Instead of forcing users onto an isolated privacy chain, RAILGUN enables native security within the existing EVM ecosystem. There are no trusted bridges, no extra validators, no liquidity fragmentations. In 2025, the protocol processed \$2 billion in combined shield/unshielded volume and held \$106 million in shielded balances.

Project Thesis

Buy thesis: RAILGUN is a bet on privacy becoming a main crypto category of this cycle. Our rationale is threefold. First, RAILGUN's design is structurally differentiated, and we believe native privacy is a better solution than a bespoke privacy chain. Second, RAILGUN benefits directly from the strongest tailwind in the sector: institutional adoption. And third, the protocol design encourages users to keep assets inside the ecosystem which reinforces the protocols moat as its userbase continues to grow.



Why Privacy

Public blockchains, such as Bitcoin and Ethereum, are designed around transparency. Every wallet, transaction, token movement, or smart contract interaction is permanently visible on chain. This is by design. Now while transparency greatly improves auditability and trustlessness, it creates a real structural problem for users, institutions, traders, and businesses, because financial activity is fully traceable.

Blockchain adoption is continuing to expand beyond experimentation into real payments, institutional finance, payroll, treasury management, consumer applications, and more. In doing so, privacy is increasingly viewed not just as a niche feature, but as necessary infrastructure.

On most blockchains today, wallet balances are public and transaction history is permanent. Anyone's trading activity, with enough effort, can easily be identified, traced, and monitored in real time on the blockchain. In doing so, trading strategies can be copied, or even front ran, all of which would be disastrous for businesses engaging in treasury movements and daily operations.

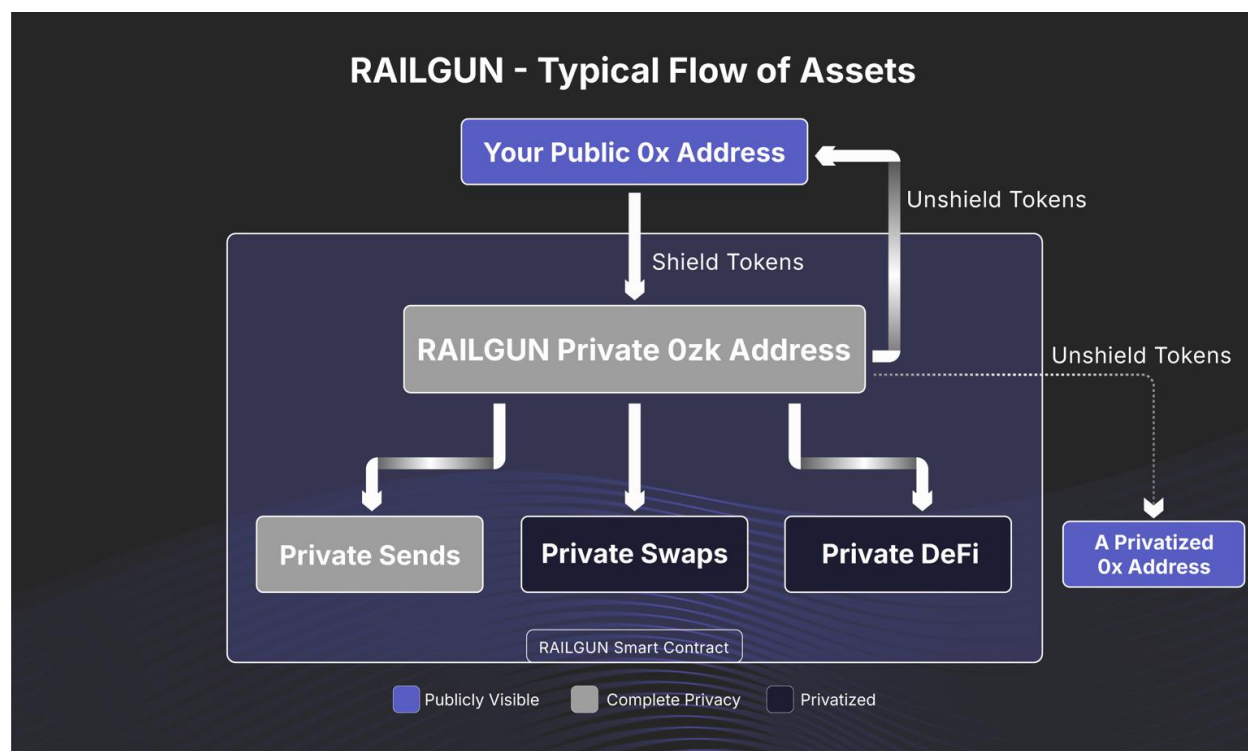
For traditional finance and, this amount of transparency is simply infeasible, especially in a world where bank accounts, and trading activity are private by default. Therefore, solutions are needed to be offered to solve this.

Specifics On Protocol

RAILGUN is a privacy protocol built on chain directly into EVM smart contracts on Ethereum. RAILGUN uses zero knowledge proofs to allow the private use of DeFi and smart contract transactions while simultaneously allowing the security of the user to not be left on chain. The users' assets are armored into a Ozk address (privately encrypted), and from that balance the user can transfer and overall interact with the interactive dApp of their choice as a zk-SNARK provides validity without revealing the sender, receiver, or amount of the transaction.

RAILGUN's privacy is guaranteed to strengthen as adoption of the protocol compounds because the privacy set is a function of total unique shield interactions, TVL in the contracts, and aggregate DeFi/private send volume which gives the protocol network effective economics.





The issue that current public blockchains are facing is a structural design of the technology, which only gets worse as more serious capital flows onto the chain because behavior is publicly available by default. This is not issue of poor UX, it is the single largest gap that separates the current state of DeFi from what is necessary for institutional, treasury, and high net worth markets/individuals.

The direct cost of information leakage is a direct cost to the subscriber; there is an intention behind each public transaction; and therefore, public transactions will provide total access and give everyone access to those who are looking to change their intention for profit. User privacy, from predatory market behavior, such as dark pools and private transaction layers, protects users and allows for the execution of large orders without being noticed, so users will receive fair market prices for their tokens; Furthermore, when using private token swaps, users can swap their tokens without revealing their wallet history, thereby reducing the chances of becoming a victim of social engineering or doxxing. For a market maker, fund, or DAO treasury, their on-chain activity is equivalent to placing their order book on public view as a market maker in real-time, therefore, transparency into the total amount of collateral deposited and withdrawn signals a market maker's intentions so anyone with knowledge of how to investigate and search for transaction history/records on a blockchain can find these financial/data records. Basic user privacy is not a luxury but is a necessary condition for sophisticated market participants that want to avoid it.



Tokenized assets of real-world assets (RWAs) will continue to grow along with their use in creating a new source of liquidity through stablecoins as well as on-chain treasury management. As this grows, selective disclosure will become inherently required from banks when executing large block trades, since the visibility to validators increases the risk of validators and miner extractable value (MEV) bots potentially front running bank transactions by using disclosed transactional information to their advantage. The underlying argument is very clear: those willing to make their payroll, profit and loss, and trading books publicly displayed will not be the ones that create the next high dollar worth of on-chain transactional volume. But the next high dollar figures will be created by banks that can demonstrate compliance with regulations and validation of trades without losing any proprietary data, of which zk-based privacy protocols are exactly what provide such a primitive.

Preventing Bad Actors

The single most important architectural differentiator RAILGUN has over every other privacy protocol, including Tornado Cash, Monero, and Zcash, is a system called Private Proofs of Innocence (PPOI) which analyzes the funds deposited by every RAILGUN user. This mechanism was deployed in 2024 for the purpose of resolving concerns over how to provide financial privacy while also not harboring bad actors using illicit funds.

The PPOI works in five steps. First, independent “List Providers” input public, non-personal, on-chain data about flagged transactions such as hacks, exploits, and sanctioned addresses. Second, when a user shields assets into RAILGUN, a mandatory standby period begins. During this “Unshield-Only Standby Period”, the user’s only available action is to return the funds to the originating address while it awaits RAILGUN’s hour-long algorithmic analysis to see whether the funds came from an illicit source. Third, a blinded ZK proof is automatically generated confirming the shielded tokens do not contain any flagged assets, thus allowing the depositor to withdraw their funds anonymously. Fourth, this proof is carried forward and attached to any transaction involving said tokens. And fifth, when these funds are transferred to a different address or are used on an exchange, the external party can verify that the PPOI proof is valid, without seeing anything about the user’s Ozk address, balance, or history.

Relevance & PPOI in Practice

In August 2022, Tornado Cash was sanctioned by OFAC for facilitating \$455 million in laundering by North Korea’s Lazarus Group. This happened because Tornado Cash



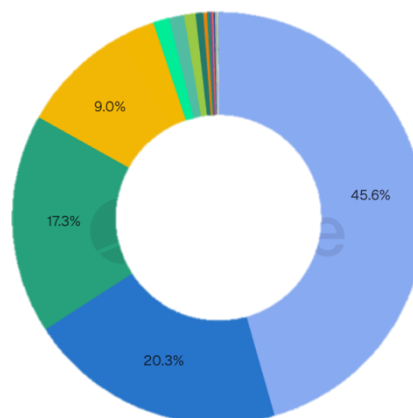
had zero screening capability; anyone could deposit and withdraw with minimal oversight. Eventually in November 2024, the Fifth Circuit ruled that OFAC had exceeded its authority and Treasury delisted Tornado Cash in March 2025. However, this legal victory came after 3 years of protocol destruction shown by sharply declining volumes, liquidity balances, and new-user flows. This emphasizes the relevance of not only the PPOI, but also what happens if a screening system is not in place.

Since the launch, Railgun's PPOI has blocked millions of dollars' worth of tokens in events such as the \$530,000 Inferno Dragon incident, and the \$9.5 million zkLend exploit which resulted in direct praise from Vitalik Buterin on how effective and compliant privacy should look in practice. The PPOI not only legalizes RAILGUN's purpose, but the system's ability to adopt specific EU or US OFAC lists, creating an adaptive and multi-jurisdictional feature that no competing L1 can replicate.

Product Market Fit

RAILGUN's adoption reveals a clear and specific use case we believe is currently under looked in the privacy sector, that being third-party wallet integration. The composition of the protocol's privacy pool highlights that's users are employing RAILGUN mainly for moving liquid, settlement-ready assets in and out of DeFi. This concentration is not by accident; instead, it reflects a user base that wishes to execute trades without broadcasting their capital flows publicly. If RAILGUN were used primarily for p2p privacy, like Monero or Zcash, then we would expect a much broader distribution of tokens, including governance tokens and yield-bearing assets. Instead, the portfolio is focused on liquidity and settlement.

Tokens in RAIL Privacy System



Token	Blockchain	Balance (USD)	% of System
wETH	Ethereum	\$43,551,747	44.04%
USDT	Ethereum	\$16,619,107	16.81%
USDC	Ethereum	\$15,949,100	16.13%
DAI	Ethereum	\$8,854,191	8.95%
USDC	Polygon	\$2,740,206	2.77%
wBTC	Ethereum	\$1,517,546	1.53%



wETH Arbitrum	\$1,260,580	1.27%
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OTC and Institutional Flows

Market makers, trading desks, and large users execute capital movements off the public record. Professional traders moving \$10M into DeFi pools over a week, or an OTC desk settling blocks of stablecoins have clear incentives to avoid:

- Exposing their positions to MEV searchers before execution
- Advertising their trading intent to competitors
- Triggering front-running on their entry/exit

RAILGUN's \$2B in annual shield/unshield volume in 2025 exhibits this use case. Furthermore, daily volume has grown consistently from \$1.7M in 2023 to now over \$5.5M, all without major token incentives or major marketing initiatives. As stablecoin volumes and usage continues to expand, RAILGUN is positioned to absorb much of the demand for private transacting. This is particularly compelling due to Ethereum maintaining its dominance with stablecoins.

Team & Contributors

RAILGUN has no corporate entity or traditional executive structure, rather, development is driven by a pseudonymous and doxed contributor community organized through RAILGUN DAO, which deliberately eliminates individual contributor risk. The core team is made up of the following:

- Emmanuel Goldstein (Co-Founder): Created RAILGUN after recognizing that institutional and retail DeFi users needed cash-equivalent privacy on-chain. Gained a master's in economics, has 10+ years in in-game currency economics, and is a former government cybersecurity contractor. Likely operates under a pseudonymous name considering that "Emmanuel Goldstein" is a fictional character in a 1984 dystopian fiction novel.
- Alan Scott (Co-Founder): The public-facing voice of RAILGUN and the protocol's most important compliance asset. Has engaged directly with federal law enforcement regarding regulatory concerns and presented at the Virtual Currency Symposium in August 2024, advocating for compliant privacy design. His proactive regulatory engagement is a key reason for why RAILGUN has avoided the legal destruction that Tornado Cash faced.



- Kieran Mesquita (Lead Developer): The primary technical mind behind RAILGUN. Began mining Bitcoin in 2010 with a background in consensus algorithms, ZK-SNARK circuit design, and cross-chain development. Previously worked as the CTO at UnityChain in Taiwan. Mesquita is responsible for building the core smart contract infrastructure for RAILGUN that has processed \$2B+ in shielded volume without a single exploit.

The Right to Privacy Foundation funded the initial development grant and it as well as the Free Software Foundation and the Electronic Frontier Foundation currently retain 25% of RAIL token supply. The Digital Currency Group (DCG) is the only venture capital firm to have funded RAILGUN with a \$10 million strategic investment in January 2022 and over \$7 million in stablecoin donations directly to RAILGUN DAO. RAILGUN has specifically turned down further outside backing in order to stay true to the decentralized ethos that the protocol was founded on.

Privacy Ecosystem & TAM

The privacy sector is growing and has shown resilience. The late 2025 early 2026 rally is not restricted to just one token. Earlier this year, roughly 80% of privacy tokens rose, with many above \$100 million market cap showing significant growth since January 1 (notably Zcash, Monero, and Dash). In April 2026, the Ethereum Foundation allocated over \$9.8 million toward core infrastructure with a significant portion targeting cryptography, zero-knowledge proofs, security, and protocol research. Privacy is quickly becoming standard infrastructure rather than a fringe feature.

Following this framework, and sizing RAILGUN's potential, we can look towards Ethereum's total market capitalization plus the stablecoin supply settling on Ethereum (RAILGUN usage is heavily concentrated on Ethereum). Currently the global stablecoin market alone is ~\$323 billion and growing, with Ethereum as the main beneficiary of this growth. Today, RAILGUN's TVL, which is on the order of \$90M+ in shielded balances represents only a fraction of this. Distribution is the core of the bull case where even a couple of basis points of wallet penetration implies multiple billions in TVL.

Key catalysts that prime RAILGUN for adoption:

- Kohaku Wallet SDK (main catalyst). Developed within the Ethereum Foundation and publicly endorsed by Vitalik, Kohaku abstracts privacy into reusable, wallet-agnostic modules. Kohaku is designed for "default but compliant" privacy, with the Foundation's dedicated privacy team actively promoting the tooling for enterprise applications like confidential payroll and



treasury management. RAILGUN's integration places it directly in the execution path for wallet-level privacy. Default integration, not a niche bespoke chain.

- Institutional/corporate treasury demand. RAILGUN's private multi-signature wallet prototype, showcased at Devconnect Argentina, targets corporate demand for confidential transactions, with Vitalik describing private multi-sig as a prerequisite for institutions. Functional multi-sig directly unlocks treasury use cases and bit flywheel for shield/unshield fee revenue.
- High-profile real usage. Vitalik has repeatedly moved funds through RAILGUN, and the Ethereum Foundation staked 50,000 RAIL tokens to support the protocol. Furthermore, recent posts indicate Ethereum's commitment to integrating privacy, much of it through RAILGUN architecture.

Competition

A large portion of the attention surrounding privacy and crypto recently has centered on privacy-native L1s such as Monero and Zcash. These protocols were designed around strong cryptographic privacy guarantees built outside the broader Ethereum DeFi ecosystem where most on-chain financial activity currently occurs. This distinction matters for DeFi users.

Type	Description	Examples	Benefits	Drawbacks
Layer-1 Privacy Chains	Privacy chains optimized for p2p transfers with transaction level confidentiality	Monero, Zcash	• Robust, proven • Privacy by default	• No programmable smart contract layer • Isolated from broader DeFi liquidity
Layer-2 Privacy Chains	General-purpose with native confidentiality, baked into smart contracts and app state	Aztec, Aleo, Mina, Secret	• Cross-chain composability (needs work) • Developer control	• Often requires proprietary languages
Privacy Apps	Tooling and middleware on top of existing L1/L2 infra – mixers, shielded pools, zkID, and compliance layers	Tornado Cash, RAILGUN, ZKP2P, Oxbow.io	• No ecosystem migration • Integrates with existing pools • Selective disclosure	• Regulatory pressure (Tornado Cash) • Lack of integration & development

While privacy L1s offer powerful anonymity, they generally lack direct composability with other dApps and liquidity that traders want to interact with daily. In practice,



users increasingly want privacy integrated directly into existing rails as opposed to isolated ecosystems. To that point, privacy infrastructure is outperforming privacy L1s in 2026.

Headwinds

Regulatory Overhang

Privacy tools are facing a volatile continually evolving regulatory environment. In the U.S, agencies such as the Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) and the Department of Justice (DOJ) continue to adjust their level of favorability towards blockchain and specifically privacy. Globally the situation is even messier, with privacy coins being banned from registered exchanges in Japan and South Korea. The EU's MiCA framework and FATF Travel Rule impose data-sharing requirements that are incompatible with strong privacy guarantees. Some jurisdictions have banned crypto activity outright. Although RAILGUN's non-custodial, permissionless architecture distances itself from others in the space, architectural nuance might be enough to avoid enforcement.

Distribution Risk & Competitive Pressure

The path to scaling rests almost entirely through wallet integration, particularly through the Kohaku Wallet SDK. If the rollout, which is ongoing, is in anyway stalled, growth will be constrained regardless of how good RAILGUN's protocol is.

Furthermore, the privacy space is increasingly filling with new players. Aztec and emerging zkVM architectures are all building toward similar goals. Any of these developments could reduce RAILGUN's addressable share of Ethereum capital flows.

Fee Structure & Governance Dilution

As mentioned earlier, RAILGUN charges a 0.25% fee on shield and unshield transactions. Depending on how users transact privately, this could potentially be a poor revenue model. As the market matures and more capital settles into privacy pools for long-term holding, fee revenue on the network will decline. So, despite healthy TVL metrics, staker distributions will compress.

RAIL additionally has a hard cap of 100 million tokens on the Ethereum network, with roughly 57.5 million currently in circulation. The DAO retains the ability to mint additional tokens through proposals with no scheduled issuance. This is a potential supply shock that could negatively impact RAIL's token price.



Differentiation & Growth



Figure 1: Relative performance of Privacy sub-categories over time, tracking their percentage gains and losses in-terms of market capitalization. Source: Coingecko

This is where RAILGUN differentiates itself, not only from L1s, but privacy focused L2s as well. The metrics backing RAILGUNS usage shows how embedded privacy tooling, into functioning financial products, is the preferred trading experience. Nullifier state growth, which is a useful metric to measure real network usage, is outpacing competitors such as Tornado Cash.

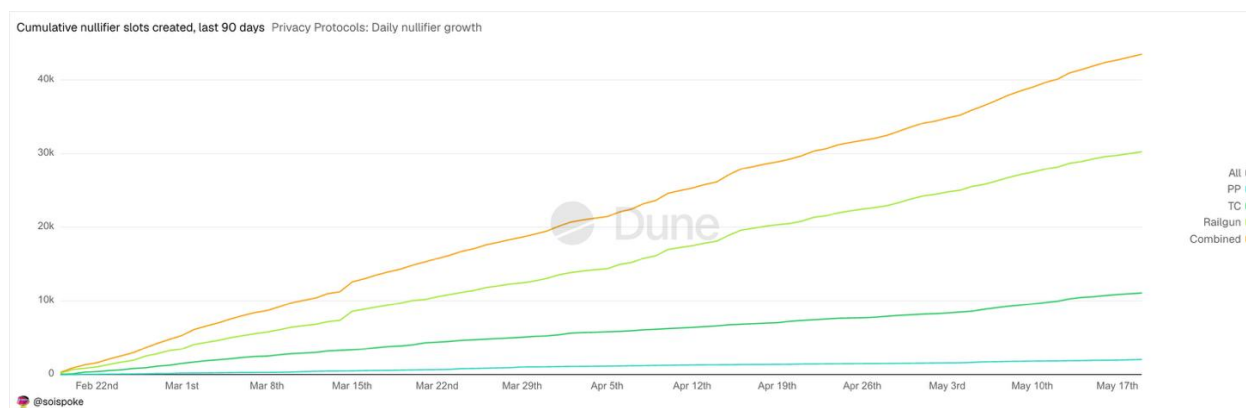


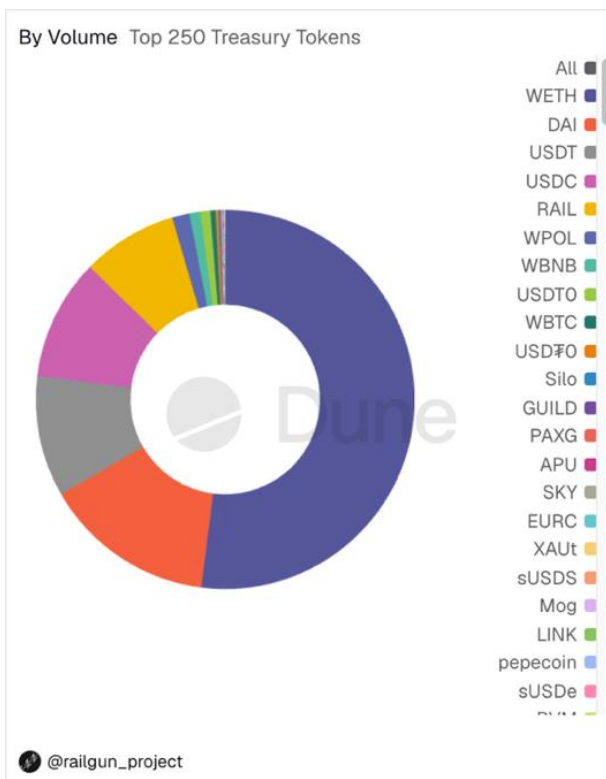
Figure 2: RAILGUN nullifier state growth outpacing competitors



Governance & Tokenomics

RAIL is the native governance and staking token of the RAILGUN ecosystem. Importantly, the token is not required to use the protocol itself, nor does holding it provide transaction privacy. Instead, the token is designed around governance participation, protocol security, and treasury incentive alignment.

Governance is community controlled, where holders can lock RAIL to become “Active Governors,” helping manage the network as well as receive allocations of wETH, RAIL, or DAI (2% of treasury tokens every 2 weeks). Rewards are distributed proportionally based on the amount of RAIL locked relative to total locked supply. The token is deployed as a standard ERC-20 token on Ethereum, with separate governance systems deployed for Polygon and BNB Smart Chain. While the protocol does have a max supply cap for each respective chain, there is currently limited public information regarding a vesting schedule or future unlock timeline.



Network	Token	Max Supply
Ethereum	RAIL	100,000,000
BNB Smart Chain	RAILBSC	44,546,789
Polygon	RAILPOLY	55,000,000

The metrics for RAIL indicate strong long-term holder conviction and overall durability of the ecosystem where over 73% of circulating supply is currently staked (\$42,240,729). This high percentage reduces immediate sell pressure, but also on the flip side could allude to potential governance concentration.

From a tokenomics perspective, RAIL does not currently include a token burn mechanism or buyback program which historically are two proven tailwinds for token appreciation. However, due to the high staking rate, we believe that growing adoption will increase rewards leading to increased token demand.



Valuation

We've based our valuation framework following Messari's own approach to RAILGUN. At a high level, the model assumes RAILGUN adoption as a downstream effect of Ethereum MCAP growth. We model total addressable market (TAM) as Ethereum market cap plus Ethereum stablecoin market cap due to RAILGUN's and stablecoin concentration on Ethereum. RAILGUN TVL is then estimated as a percentage penetration of this TAM, with adoption increasing gradually over time across bear, base, and bull scenarios.

In accordance with Messari Conditions:

- **Bear:** Assumes slower Ethereum capital formation, low privacy-set penetration, and compressed margins, coupled with a conservative valuation multiple and a higher discount rate.
- **Base:** Reflects steady growth in Ethereum's capital base, moderate RAILGUN adoption, stable fee capture, and mid-range valuation parameters.
- **Bull:** Strong TAM expansion, meaningful adoption of RAILGUN as a wallet-integrated privacy infrastructure, sustained shielded asset turnover rates, and premium pricing dynamics.

TAM Penetration Assumptions

Case	TAM Penetration	Rationale
Bear	0.03% → 0.05%	Limited wallet integration keeps privacy adoption niche despite continued Ethereum capital growth.
Base	0.10% → 0.50%	Privacy becomes standard for select workflows as wallet SKD distribution matures.
Bull	0.25% → 0.75%	Private balances integrate broadly across wallets, enabling institutional and high-value use

Source: Messari

An important dynamic in RAILGUN'S revenue model is its shield/unshield fee, which is the protocol's sole source of revenue. Therefore, realized revenue is dictated by turnover within the privacy set. As RAILGUN's TVL continues to grow, Messari identified that a change in user base could alter the dynamic weakening revenue capture.



Revenue Capture Assumptions

Case	Revenue Capture	Rationale
Bear	3.00% → 2.00%	Limited adoption keeps turnover resilient, but growth and velocity remain constrained
Base	3.00% → 0.70%	Broader adoption lowers transaction velocity as private balances become persistent.
Bull	3.00% → 0.50%	Widespread integration commoditizes privacy, compressing fees despite large-scale adoption.

Source: Messari

- **Bear case:** \$0.37 per RAIL
- **Base case:** \$6.26 per RAIL
- **Bull case:** \$16.36 per RAIL

RAIL Multiples Analysis

In addition to our cash-flow based valuation, we also looked at RAIL through FDV/revenue framework commonly used across DeFi. While less rigorous, it provides a way to compare across assets. We apply scenario-based revenue multiples of 5x, 10x, and 20x, to Year-5 projected protocol revenue to reflect bearish, base, and bull cases.

Implied FDV = Revenue Multiple x Year-5 Revenue

Implied Token Value = Implied FDV / Circulating Supply

Metric	Value
Market Cap / FDV	~\$88M
Annualized Revenue	~\$4.53M
Holder Revenue	~\$1.77M
TVL	~\$93M
FDV / Revenue	~19.4x
FDV / Holder Revenue	~49.7x
Revenue / TVL	~4.9%

Revenue capture remains extremely high at roughly 4.9% of TVL, above most large DeFi protocols. Aave: 0.4%, Lido: 0.3%, Sky: 2.3%, SushiSwap: 3.3%. Historically, RAILGUN's revenue capture has been between 5-13% highlighting the protocols unique position.



At the current FDV/Revenue multiple of ~19.4x, RAIL is already pricing in meaningful growth expectations. Our multiples analysis brackets the range of outcomes depending on how the market assigns value to future revenue expansion:

- **Bear:** \$0.76
- **Base:** \$11.61
- **Bull:** \$38.02

Taken together with the DCF-based analysis, a range of \$6.26-\$11.61 provides a reasonable valuation anchor, suggesting RAIL at its current price of \$3.98 is trading at a discount.

Fund Recommendation

Portfolio Fit

Oregon Blockchain Group's current sub-DAO portfolio is heavily concentrated in HYPE (48.17%) with the remainder split across ETH, PENDLE, LINK, SKY, and most recently PUMPCADE. Notably, we have no exposure to the privacy sector, and no position specifically tied to a revenue distribution (HYPE does buybacks, LINK has a treasury, etc.). RAIL can fill this gap.

Thesis Summary

RAIL trades at \$3.98 against a base case intrinsic value of \$6.26 – a 36% discount. Potential Kohaku SDK distribution could further this price to \$11.61-\$15+ potentially. With a 192% gain since May 18th, it's difficult to say how much and what is priced in. The token doubling in price over a weekend suggests a re-rating by the market as Kohaku gains more traction. To recap our main thesis points:

- Revenue capture is real and verifiable. The protocol is currently generating ~\$4.53M annualized, with ~\$1.77M flowing directly to stakers via the 52% distribution rate
- Kohaku SDK adoption has the potential to take RAILGUN from a niche tool to embedded infrastructure. Integration over the next 12-18 months will be crucial

Looking beyond RAIL's weekend rally, we must also consider the risks. The concerns around distribution, regulation, revenue capture, and competition are real and must be considered. That said, the asymmetry remains favorable. Even after the recent



move, a base upside of ~57% and bull case upside upward of 200%+ still outweighs the bear case scenario.

After our analysis, we've concluded that a meaningful but contained allocation is best. To fund the position, we recommend liquidating our LINK position and covering the remaining amount with ETH. Our Chainlink position is down -26.29% USD, -1.89% ETH, since our purchase in November 2025. There is no clear near term catalyst, and the treasury narrative has been slow moving.

(Buy/Swap) for 1.5 \$ETH of (Token, \$---) Hold Period estimated 12-18 months

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**** full URL's - on a separate page**

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